

1) Texture Type

Changed to “Image or movie.”

2) Preview window

Can be set to display “texture” or “material” or “Both”

3) Colours panel

An image can be adjusted if colours are not quite what you want.

4) Mapping panel

Textures can be projected as Flat, Cube, Tube or Sphere onto an object.

You can also adjust the offset and size of a texture.

5) Coordinate Mapping

New default settings have this set to UV.

6) Image panel

This is where you open the image or movie you wish to use as your texture.

7) Image sampling panel

This is where you make adjustments to your images such as alpha.

8) Image mapping panel

This where you would adjust the tiling of your textures. You also have mirror options in case the image you’re using doesn’t appear seamless.

You will notice that by default the image is mapped onto the top and stretched down the sides of the object. This is called “Flat” mapping. This can be adjusted in the “Mapping” panel. If your textures appear too big, you can adjust the “Repeat” parameter under the “Image mapping” panel. There are other mapping options that are available, that you can apply smartly depending on the general shape of the 3D model. Simple 3D models can be made to look much more complex through the smart use of textures. Remember that the material and texture panels work in union. So, if the brick looks good but is a bit glossy and flat, you can make adjustments to the specular attribute in the materials panel. Add a Normal map to the brick texture in the texture panel under “Influence” to simulate depth and create a realistic effect to the brick.